

How to give a talk

Lars Pastewka



Moto Q



BlackBerry



Palm Treo



Nokia E62

Talk

There is only one rule

Tell a (simple) story

(This means you need to know what your story is)

Corollary

Everything that does not help your story needs to be cut (“less is more”)

Slide needs to flow logically

Slides

One message per slide

Your story flows through the messages

(Message could be: “Kokkos is slower than CUDA”)

Support the message with (conclusive and logical) data!

Support the message with display items (one per slide)

One display item per slide

(2 are okay as well)

As little text as possible

While somebody reads you your slide, she won't listen to what you have to say

Minimum font size is 18pt for text (14pt for references)

Preparation

Practice

Often (you will be nervous)

More often (if you give talks in groups)

Learn by heart

The first three sentences

(But not the rest)

Polish your slides

Nice figures

Consistent font

Don't overlap figure or logos with each other

Dos

Face the audience

Do not look at your slides (for extended periods of time) while talking

Explain what your graphs show one-by-one

“The x-axis displays ...”

“The y-axis display...”

“This graphs shows...”

Acknowledge external sources

If you take a graph from a paper or website, you need to add a citation to the slide pointing to the original source

Don'ts

Timing

- Don't run over time

- Absolute minimum is one minute per slide

Excuses

- “This is the first time I am giving this talk. It will be terrible.”

Lies

- Stretching data to fit your hypothesis

Outline/table of contents slide

- The audience will have forgotten 30 seconds from now

References

- Single slide at the end with all references

- (Reference need to be on the same slide as figure/text that you want to reference)

Tools

Commercial

PowerPoint (Windows, macOS)

Keynote (macOS)

SoftMaker Office (Windows, Linux, macOS) - <https://www.softmaker.de/>

Free

OnlyOffice (Windows, Linux, macOS)

WPS Office (Windows, Linux, macOS)

Open source

LibreOffice Impress

Quarto (Markdown) - <https://quarto.org/>

Beamer (LaTeX)

Jupyter Notebooks - <https://mljar.com/blog/jupyter-notebook-presentation/>

Marino Notebooks - <https://marimo.io/>

This was a terrible talk

(Why?)

Further reading

Bourne, PLoS Comput. Biol. 3, e77 (2007) - <https://doi.org/10.1371/journal.pcbi.0030077>

Fleming, Nature 564, S84-S85 (2018) - <https://doi.org/10.1038/d41586-018-07780-5>

A man with short brown hair, wearing a light blue button-down shirt over a black t-shirt, stands behind a white podium. The podium has a red rectangular sign on top with the text 'Strata Hadoop' and 'WORLD' below it. The background is dark and out of focus.

Strata Hadoop

WORLD

Strata+Hadoop

MACIEJ CEGŁOWSKI
FOUNDER